

CATALOGUE

مغيبه

ABSENTED

Group Exhibition

11-24 NOVEMBER 2026
WASL GALLERY | غاليري وصل
JORDAN NATIONAL GALLERY OF FINE ARTS | AMMAN, JORDAN
CURATED BY MAY QADOURA

ARTISTS:
AMANDA THOMPSON ·
DEVON MCCULLOCH ·
REEM ALI ACASON ·
MAI ABOASSI ·
MAY QADOURA ·
VICTORIA KOCH.

Absented مغنية

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CURATED BY MAY QADOURA
FEATURING THE WORK OF AMANDA THOMPSON, DEVON MCCULLOCH, MAI ABOASSI, MAY
QADOURA, REEM ALI ACASON & VICTORIA KOCH

ABOUT THE ARTIST

Amanda
Thompson

Amanda is a multidisciplinary artist with a strong foundation in traditional drawing. Curiosity is at the heart of her practice. She enjoys exploring materials, experimenting with what they can do, and allowing the process of making to shape the work.

Her practice moves between psychological realism and surrealism, exploring the different sides of lived experience. She uses art as a way of expressing, processing and understanding emotions and feelings that arise throughout her life. Her sketchbooks have always been an important way of managing and making sense of her experiences.

Getting sober gave Amanda the opportunity to let go of things that were no longer working for her and created the space to become the artist she is today. Her work reflects this ongoing process of healing, change and moving forward, while also making space for celebration, grief, humour and everything in between.

As she enters a new seven-year cycle, her practice will continue to grow and evolve alongside her understanding of who she is now. Post-menopause marks another significant threshold in her life, bringing with it a new perspective on identity, change and becoming.

Her work is a record of that ongoing journey: what is left behind, what remains, and what might emerge next.





Absented reflects on a threshold between what has been and what remains. Seven years of sobriety and the end of PMDD mark a significant shift in my identity, experiences that shaped my life and are now absent.

At the centre, a stitched labyrinth traces cycles, repetitions, dead ends and gradual movement towards something new. Seven textile squares represent seven years of sobriety, forming a physical record of change and recovery.

Made from reclaimed fabrics and hand-dyed threads, the work embraces slowness and mindful making. The layers and stitches become traces of an identity shaped by survival, asking what remains when those experiences begin to loosen.

Who have I become without them?

I am still becoming: artist, woman, elder.

Not starting again. Beginning from here.



7 YEARS

AMANDA THOMPSON

2026

61 x 61 cm

Hand-sewn, using recycled, repurposed
fabric, dyed fabric and threads.

مَغِيْبَةٌ
ABSENTED

ABOUT THE ARTIST

Devon
McCulloch

Devon McCulloch is a multi-disciplinary artist whose work explores and uses modern technology in unconventional ways, including but not limited to X-Rays, medical paraphernalia and historical documents such as passports, and ID cards. These investigations operate within the genre of anti-portraiture: portraits that reject art historical conventions to challenge assumptions about representation and subjectivity.

The work presented here, interrogates identity by fusing modern and historical documents into a methodology that confronts the viewer with questions of origin, identity, and mortality. She is drawn to the fragmented narrative potential of these objects, as they serve as both institutional records and deeply personal artefacts. In doing so, she examines the emotional weight embedded in these bureaucratic relics and how they shape, limit, and define our lives.



DEVON MCCULLOCH

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Departed is an artwork that consists of nine separate A1 sized panels of black fabric on which a passport photograph has been laser etched. This process causes the image to invert and allows usually unseen holograms to be revealed. These consist of a circular diagrammatic halo, a compass, bird and wave motifs which relate directly to movement and travel. Using the passport photograph as a device, I contemplate the conception of a modern citizen. This standardised photograph illuminates the contradiction between freedom and restriction, (international travel is curtailed without one). As an artist I am drawn to this bureaucratic aesthetic, the passport itself and how it functions in portraiture. I value these images because every traveller must adhere to the same set of instructions. A universally, forward facing, unsmiling, and emotional vacant portrait, similarly comparable to a classic mugshot. A moment, captured in time in which the holder declares to the state that this is their identity, and over time a permanent archive of memory for journeys taken and a lifetime lived. As part of the *Absented* exhibition, this artwork positions itself in the moments of arrival and departure as physical presence gives way to the ephemeral passenger.



DEPARTED

Departed
2026
Digital Passport Photo, laser etching, cotton fabric
2523mm x 1782 mm

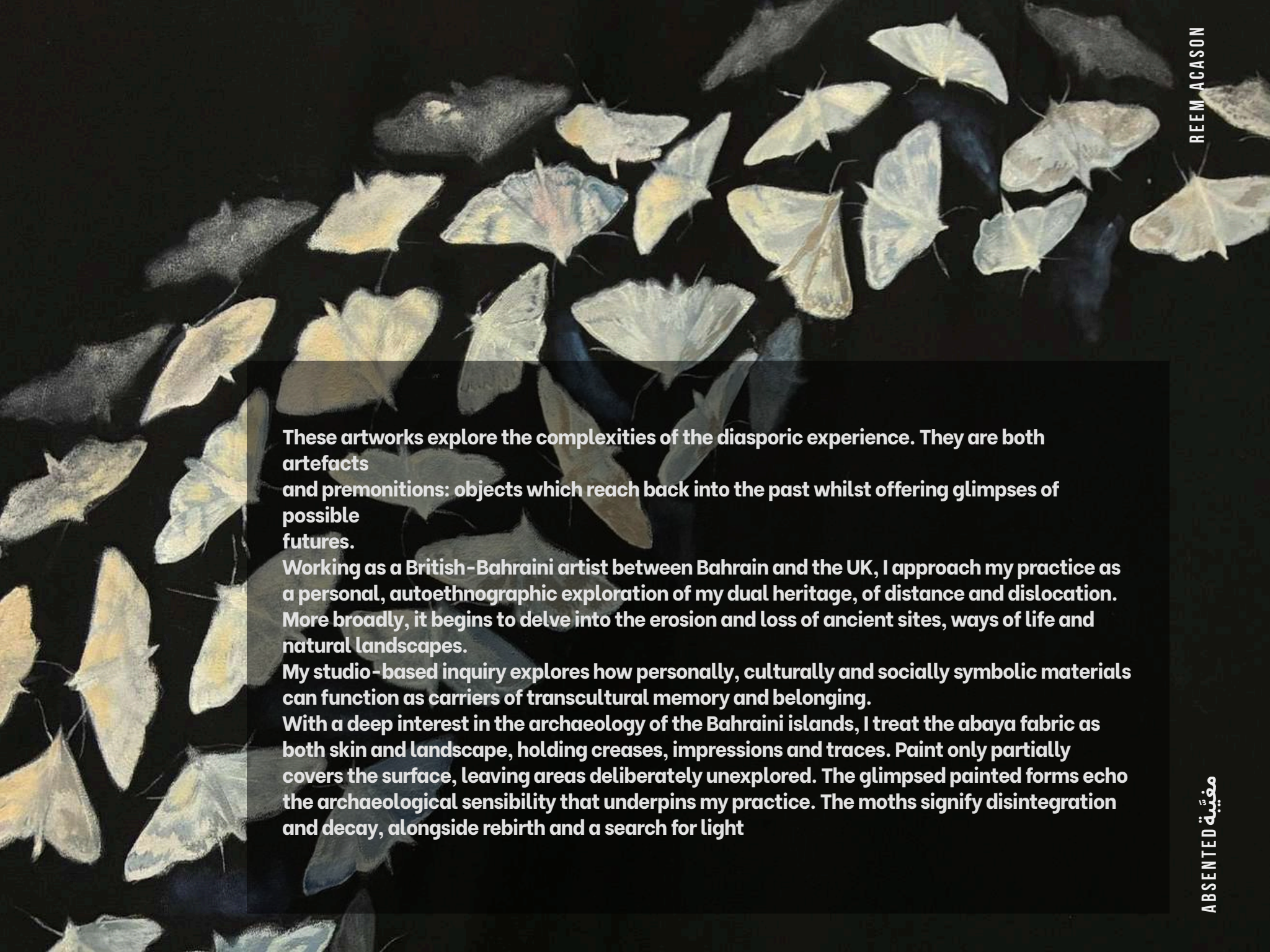
ABOUT THE ARTIST

Reem Ali
Acason

Reem Ali Acason is a British-Bahraini artist based in southeast England whose practice explores memory, geographical transformation and heritage through the lens of archaeological fragmentation. She holds a BA in Fine Art from the University of Greenwich, an MA in Fine Art from the University of Brighton and is currently undertaking her PhD at the University of Brighton with a fully funded TC25 Award.

Working at the intersection of painting and installation, Reem uses materials and processes including oil painting on fabric, wax, sand, gypsum, and vintage objects. These materials are imbued with personal, social, and cultural meaning, allowing each work to act as an artefact or relic. Through juxtaposition and re-contextualisation, she seeks new means of understanding and a deeper relationship with her lived experience as a mixed-heritage British Bahraini. Reem's work has been exhibited widely in the UK and internationally including the Royal Academy Summer Exhibition, the ING Discerning Eye in London, 35Blumen, Germany and ArtBab International Art Fair, Bahrain, and her work is held in private collections worldwide.



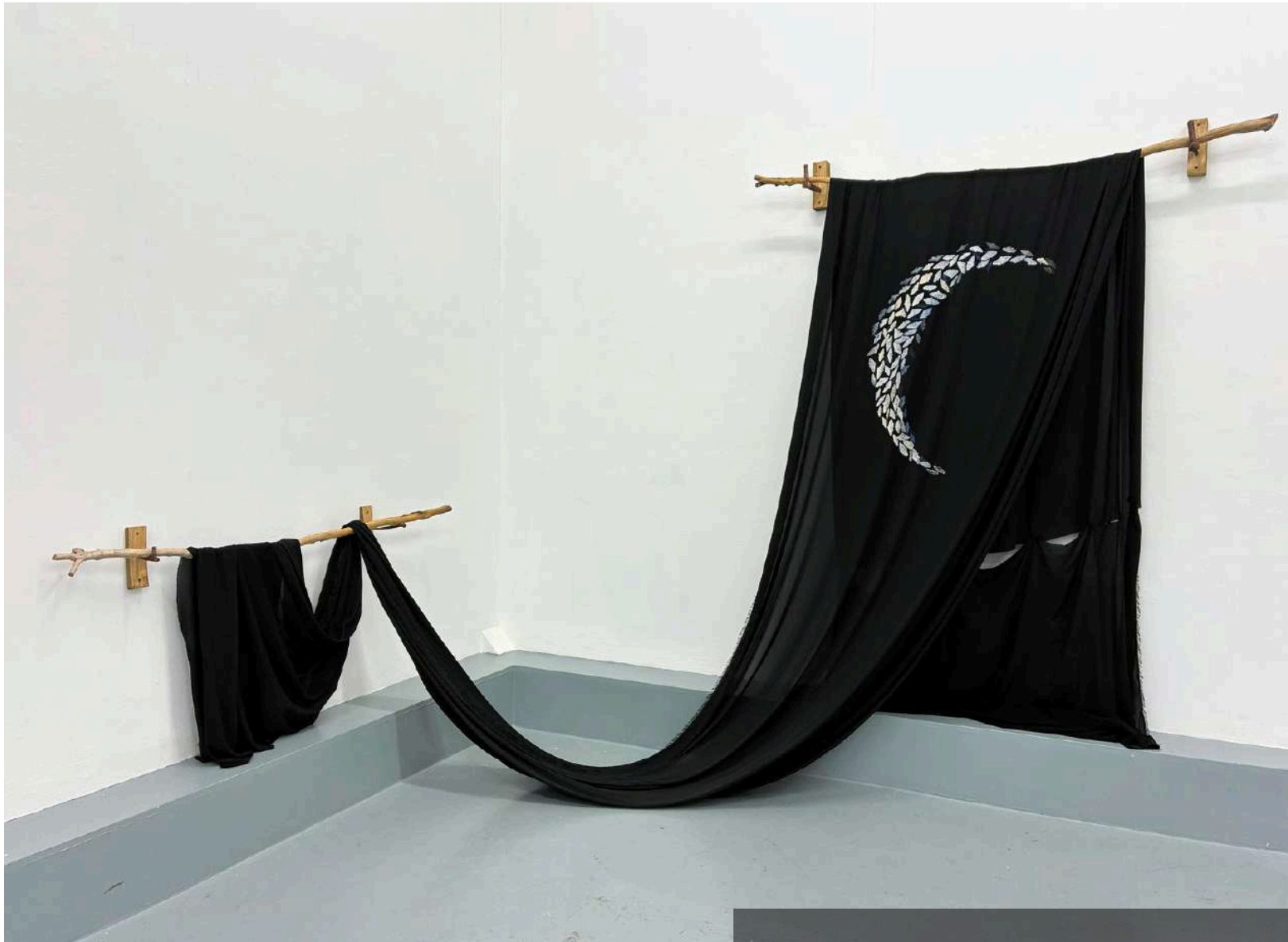


These artworks explore the complexities of the diasporic experience. They are both artefacts and premonitions: objects which reach back into the past whilst offering glimpses of possible futures.

Working as a British-Bahraini artist between Bahrain and the UK, I approach my practice as a personal, autoethnographic exploration of my dual heritage, of distance and dislocation. More broadly, it begins to delve into the erosion and loss of ancient sites, ways of life and natural landscapes.

My studio-based inquiry explores how personally, culturally and socially symbolic materials can function as carriers of transcultural memory and belonging.

With a deep interest in the archaeology of the Bahraini islands, I treat the abaya fabric as both skin and landscape, holding creases, impressions and traces. Paint only partially covers the surface, leaving areas deliberately unexplored. The glimpsed painted forms echo the archaeological sensibility that underpins my practice. The moths signify disintegration and decay, alongside rebirth and a search for light



PREPARATIONS FOR A LUNAR ECLIPSE III

2026

Abaya fabric, oil paint, branches, vintage hinges, scraps of wood
520cm x 215cm

REEM ACASON

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ABSENTED



**PREPARATIONS FOR A LUNAR ECLIPSE III
(DETAIL)**

2026

Abaya fabric, oil paint, branches, vintage hinges, scraps of wood

520cm x 215cm



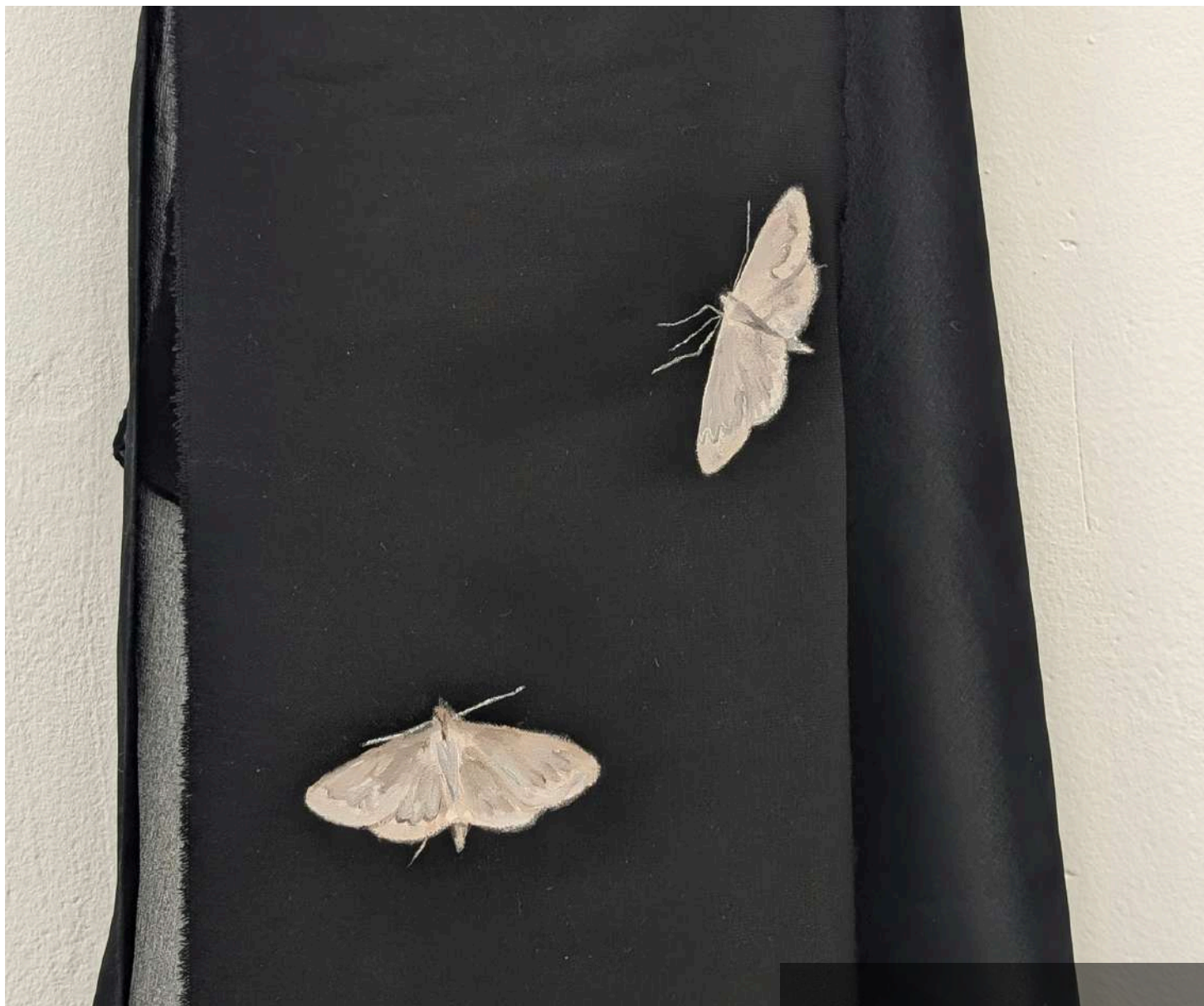
PREPARATIONS FOR A LUNAR ECLIPSE II

REEM ACASON

2026

Abaya fabric, oil paint, branch, vintage hook, scrap of wood
50cm x 175cm

مغيبة
ABSENTED



PREPARATIONS FOR A LUNAR ECLIPSE II (DETAIL)

2026
Abaya fabric, oil paint, branch, vintage hook, scrap of wood
50cm x 175cm

ABOUT THE ARTIST

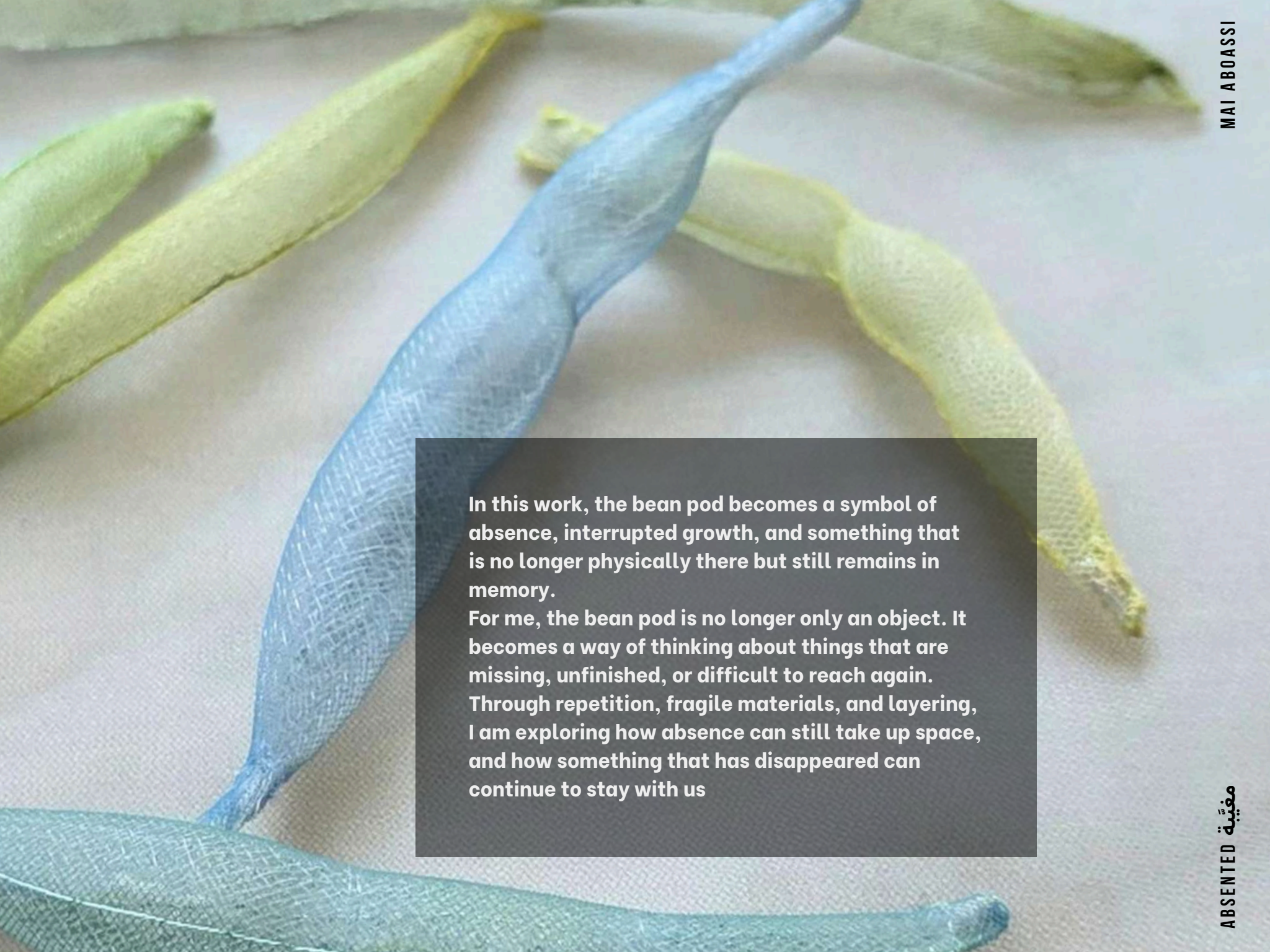
Mai
Aboassi

Mai Aboassi is an Egyptian contemporary artist, born in Oman in 1997 and raised in Cairo. Her multidisciplinary practice explores memory, emotion, absence, and transformation through textiles, drawing, installation, and autobiographical zines. Working with transparent and delicate materials including tulle, lace, thread, and tracing paper, she creates layered works in which forms move between visibility and disappearance. Recurring motifs drawn from memory and the subconscious develop into a personal visual language concerned with repression, recollection, and the ways emotional experiences persist over time.

Aboassi received her MA in Fine Art from the University of Brighton in 2023, where her research investigated the subconscious and repressed memory through textile-based installation. Her practice has also been informed by her Art in Medicine Fellowship.

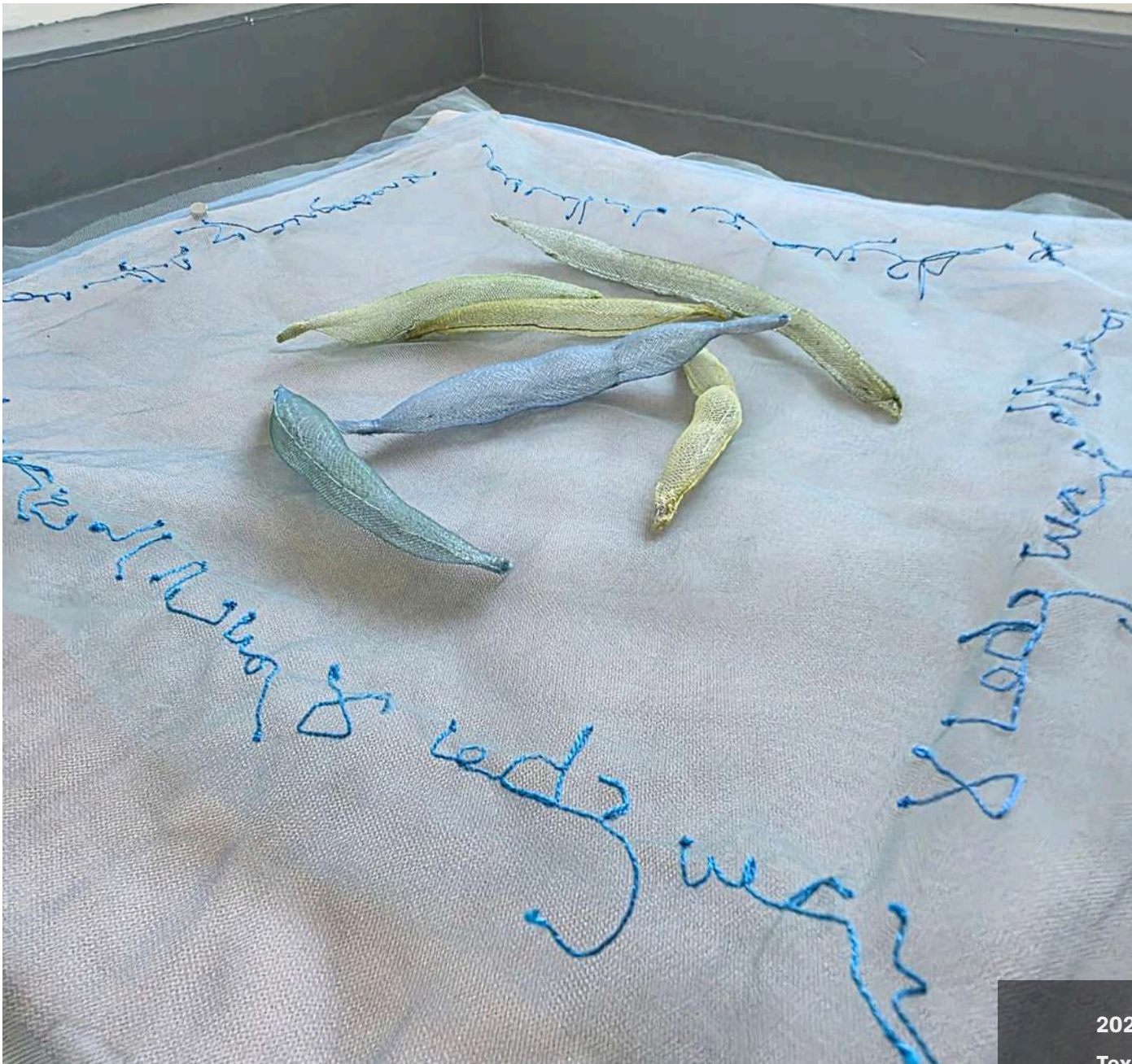
She has exhibited in the UK, Egypt, and internationally, including at Cairo Opera House, the London Biennale, ITSLIQUID Group exhibitions, and OXO Gallery in London. In 2026, she curated and exhibited in Land of a Memory at Lewisham Arthouse, further developing her interest in collective memory, material storytelling, and exhibition-making.





In this work, the bean pod becomes a symbol of absence, interrupted growth, and something that is no longer physically there but still remains in memory.

For me, the bean pod is no longer only an object. It becomes a way of thinking about things that are missing, unfinished, or difficult to reach again. Through repetition, fragile materials, and layering, I am exploring how absence can still take up space, and how something that has disappeared can continue to stay with us



THE MARGINALISED FAVA BEAN PODS

2026

Textile Installation
40 width X 43 hight CM.

ABOUT ME

May
Qadoura

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PORTRAIT | FOOD | STREET

PHOTOGRAPHY



MAY QADOURA

معيّة
ABSENTED

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My studio-based inquiry explores how personally, culturally and socially symbolic materials can function as carriers of transcultural memory and belonging.

With a deep interest in the archaeology of the Bahraini islands, I treat the abaya fabric as both skin and landscape, holding creases, impressions and traces. Paint only pa

ABOUT THE ARTIST

Victoria
Koch

Victoria Koch is a visual artist based in Sussex, UK, whose practice moves between material investigation and psychological enquiry. Holding an MA in Fine Art from the University of Brighton and a BSc in Drama and Psychology, Koch draws on an interdisciplinary framework to explore the concept of lost futures – concerned not with what is visibly present, but with the haunting resonance of the unrealised: the timelines and narratives that failed to manifest, leaving behind traces like a palimpsest.

Through experimental photography and sculptural intervention, Koch captures and folds time and place, collapsing distinct temporalities into a single plane. She has exhibited across the UK, including Materiality at the Handbag Factory, Vauxhall, and Fault Lines in Brighton. Koch is currently undertaking a PhD at the University of Brighton, extending her research into displacement, material instability, and the affective weight of unrealised futures.



VICTORIA KOCH

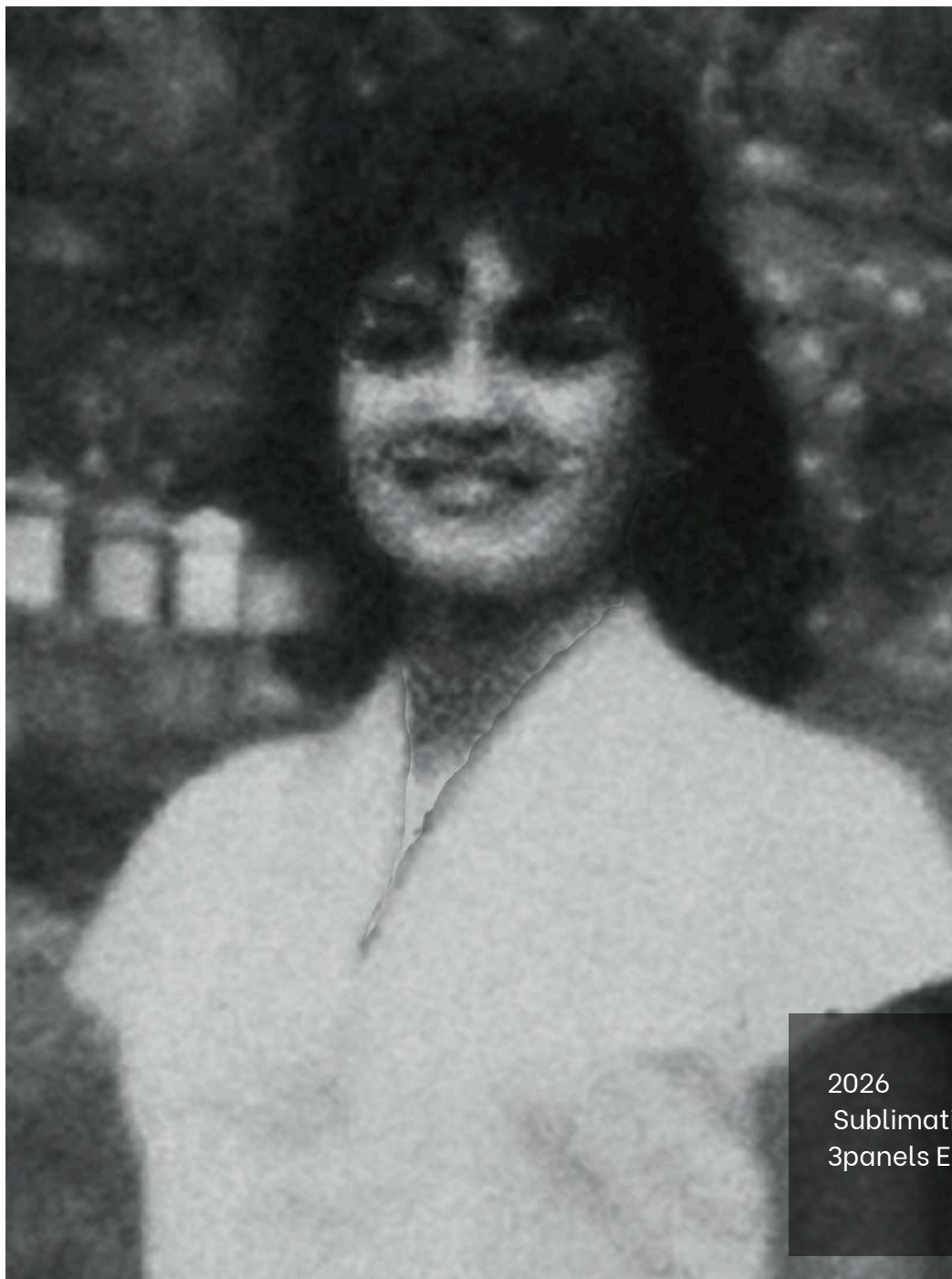
Out of Register brings together three photographs printed on sheer fabric and hung so you can see through one to the next. One is from my family archive. One is the pattern of an old iron grate I walk past every day in my village. One is an unidentifiable shape – futuristic perhaps – drifting through a dark wood. The panels never line up, so every view is a double exposure the viewer makes themselves.

My work is concerned with the spectral quality of memory and anticipation. In Out of Register three photographs hang as sheer panels that never align, so each is seen through the others. Nothing in them is fully present or fully absent. They are all out of place and displaced in time. Partly Absented from where and when the audience views them.



PROJECT TITLE HERE

2026
Sublimation Print on Feather Voile
3panels Each panel is 50cm x 300cm



OUT OF REGISTER (DETAIL)

VICTORIA KOCH

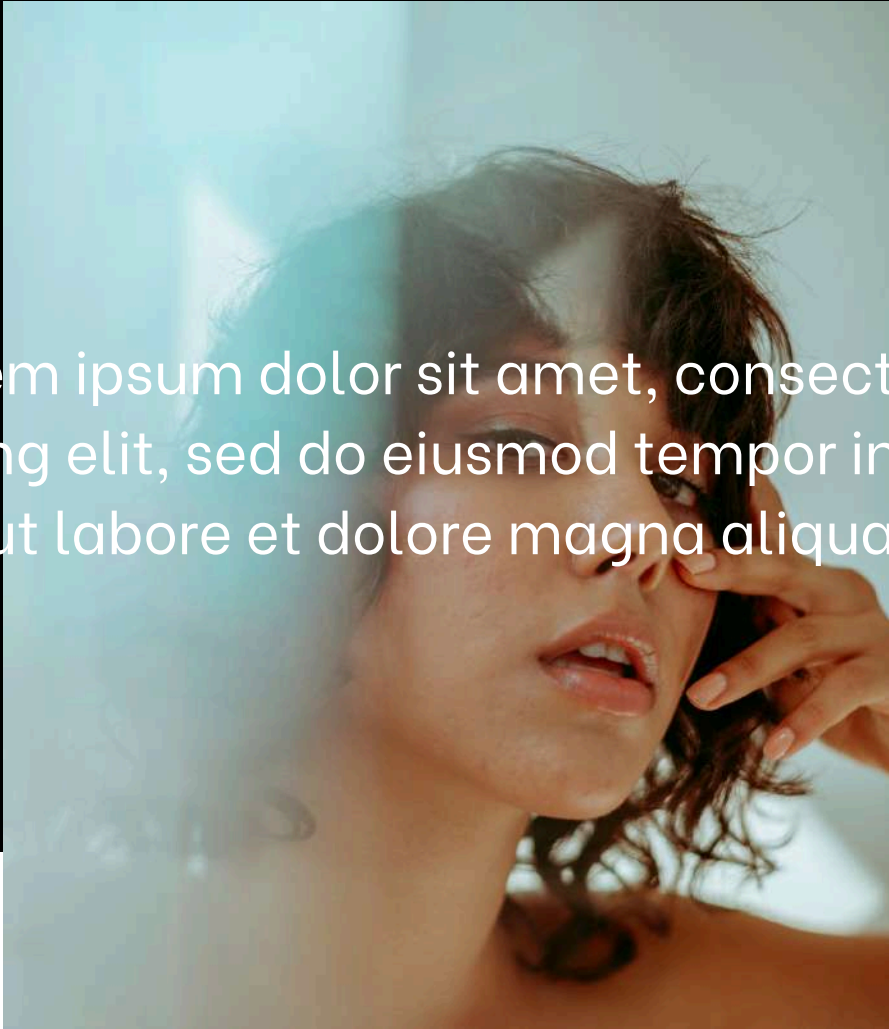
2026
Sublimation Print on Feather Voile
3panels Each panel is 50cm x 300cm

مغيبة
ABSENTED

PROJECT TITLE HERE



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A close-up photograph of a woman's face, partially obscured by her hand. The image has a soft, ethereal quality with a light blue and white color palette, suggesting a dreamlike or artistic theme. The woman's features are soft, and her hand is gently touching her face.

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PROJECT TITLE HERE



PROJECT
TITLE HERE

2026
Textile Installation
40 width X 43 hight CM.



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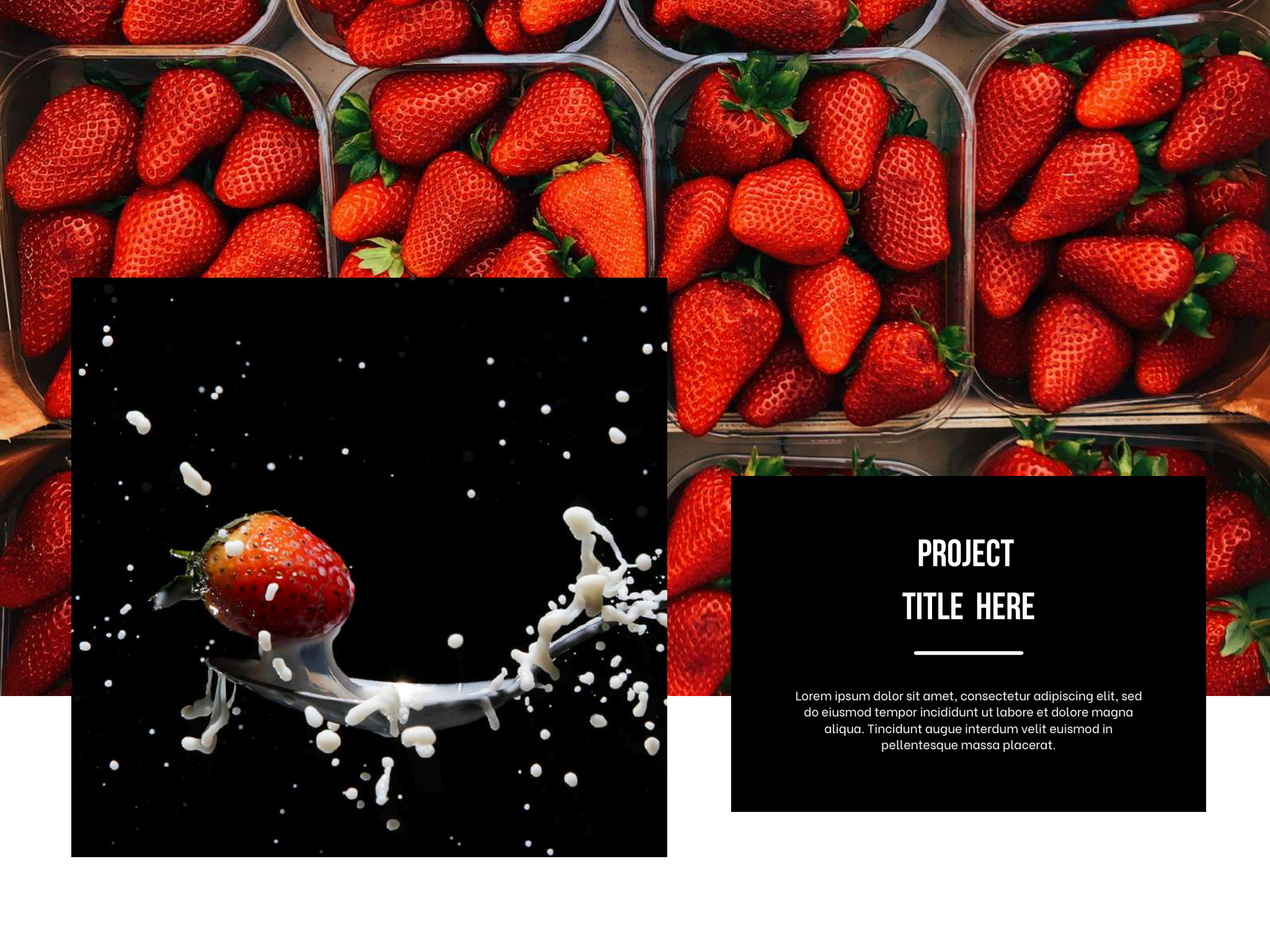
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PROJECT 02

FOOD PHOTOGRAPHY

PROJECT 02



PROJECT TITLE HERE

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A high-angle, black and white photograph of a busy city street. The street is marked with white diagonal stripes and features tram tracks running across it. Numerous pedestrians are visible, their figures blurred to convey a sense of motion and a crowded environment. The perspective is from directly above, looking down on the street.

PROJECT 03

STREET PHOTOGRAPHY

PROJECT 03

PROJECT TITLE HERE

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HOPE TO WORK
WITH YOU
Soon

+123-456-7890

hello@reallygreatsite.com

www.reallygreatsite.com

@reallygreatsite

Reem Ali Acason

Preparations for a Lunar Eclipse II

2026

Abaya fabric, oil paint, branch, vintage hook, scrap of wood

50cm x 175cm

Reem Ali Acason

Preparations for a Lunar Eclipse III

2026

Abaya fabric, oil paint, branches, vintage hinges, scraps of wood

520cm x 215cm

Mai Aboassi

The Marginalised Fava Bean Pods

2026

Textile Installation

40 width X 43 hight CM.

Victoria Kosh

Out of Register

2026

Sublimation Print on Feather Voile

3panels Each panel is 50cm x 300cm

Devon McCulloch

Departed

2026

Digital Passport Photo, laser etching, cotton fabric

2523mm x 1782 mm

Amanda Thompson

7years

2026

61 x 61 cm

**Hand-sewn, using recycled, repurposed
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